

Exam practice

Reading and Use of English Part 7

You are going to read an article about four people describing their favourite type of media. For questions 1–10, choose from the people (A–D). The people may be chosen more than once.

Which person

says that they ignored someone else's opinion?

1	
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mentions how they started to develop a daily routine?

2	
---	--

is aware that their interest in a type of media is illogical?

3	
---	--

describes a type of media that has lasted although it wasn't expected to?

4	
---	--

describes a feeling of anticipation?

5	
---	--

appreciates being shown a lifestyle they will never have?

6	
---	--

does not share a common reaction that people have?

7	
---	--

mentions how much mental effort is required by a type of media?

8	
---	--

appreciates being able to find something to suit their mood?

9	
---	--

mentions the increasing popularity of a type of media?

10	
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A Eleanor

Radio is still alive, despite all the predictions. It has been around for so long that it is part of the scenery. However much TV opens the eyes, I still love to close mine and listen. And I'm not the only one, as listening figures are rising again. In fact, despite iPods and downloads and podcasts, 91% of us still listen to a radio station each week. For me this comes as no surprise. It's the only medium that still requires my imagination to work hard. We can't see the people talking; we have to picture them and, more importantly, to really listen to what they're saying rather than getting distracted by their haircut or clothes as you might do watching TV. And of course, the voices we hear age slower and change less than faces.

A Theo

It may be unfashionable, but I love my daily newspaper. I know I could get the same things on my iPad or smartphone, but for me, nothing quite beats the feeling of sitting down with my newspaper every morning. It's like that moment when the orchestra starts to play, before the theatre curtain rises. You're not sure exactly what's going to happen, but you know you'll enjoy the experience. I didn't discover newspapers until I first began working in the city. While my bus journey lasted 45 minutes, the emotional journey of reading the newspaper took me much further. By the time I arrived, I would feel interested, informed and ready to face the day. While I often look at online news for the latest updates, it is simply not the same as turning the pages of a newspaper.

C Alessandro

TV is my favourite, much more than newspapers, radio, or even the internet. An evening on my sofa with the TV guide in front of me – I love it. There's so much to choose from! Sometimes if I'm tired or fed up, I'll watch a silly comedy but if I've had a boring day, I'll look for something more exciting or maybe informative. A lot of people say they feel guilty when they're watching television. That's because it's easily available and requires a minimum amount of effort, whereas for other forms of entertainment you might have to go out or dress up or talk to other people. I have to say I don't feel this way – for me it's pure pleasure.

D Katarina

Although my parents never actually banned my sister and me from buying glossy magazines, they didn't approve of them either. They thought them silly and irrelevant, but from the first moment I flipped through a fashion magazine, I was hooked. It's strange really, as I don't particularly care about fashion. Yet each month I read articles about beauty treatments and look at dresses that cost more than my monthly rent. I am very aware that I am an outsider, looking in at a life I don't live. But from the very beginning, these glimpses into other lives have been a large part of why I love glossy magazines: they provided different perspectives, different ways to exist in the world. Of course, they aren't perfect. They are the end product of several thriving industries: advertising, entertainment, big business. I've stopped purchasing many of them because they became just too distant from my lifestyle, but I could never give them up entirely.



Exam tip

Underline the answer to each question in the text and check that the words in the text mean exactly the same as the question.

Writing Part 2: review

You see this notice on an international website.

TV reviews wanted

Is there a TV series in your country that has been popular for a long time?

Write us a review describing the series. Explain why it is popular, whether it is suitable for different age groups and whether you think viewers in other countries would enjoy it too.

The best reviews will be posted on the website next month.

Write your **review** (140–190 words).